SLEEP (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 1 – Enchantment
Casting Time: Action · Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a pinch of sand or rose petals) · Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute
Classes: Bard, Sorcerer, Wizard

Each creature you choose in a **5-foot-radius Sphere** centered on a point within range must make a **Wisdom saving throw**. On a failed save, it has the **Incapacitated** condition until the end of its next turn, when it repeats the save. If it fails the second save, it has the **Unconscious** condition for the duration.

The spell ends on a target if it takes damage or if a creature within 5 feet of it takes an action to shake it awake.

Creatures that don't sleep, such as elves, or that have immunity to the Exhaustion condition automatically succeed on the saves.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You choose a point within 60 ft: a 5-ft-radius Sphere.
2. Each chosen target makes a Wisdom save.
3. Failure: Incapacitated until the end of its next turn, then a new save.
4. Second failure: Unconscious for the duration, unless damaged or shaken awake.

⚠ Change from 2014

In 2014, the spell put to sleep a pool of Hit Points, with no saving throw, starting with the weakest. In 2024, it is **two successive Wisdom saves**.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say what can be done with an Unconscious creature or whether waking by action is automatic. Fix: stick to the **Incapacitated** and **Unconscious** conditions and announce waking rules.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe heavy eyelids, a yawn, a body slowly slumping.

Step 1 – Choose the point:

A point within 60 ft: the Sphere has a 5-ft radius. You choose the creatures affected inside it.

Step 2 – First save:

Each chosen creature makes a **Wisdom** save against your spell save DC. Failure: **Incapacitated** until the end of its next turn.

Step 3 – Second save:

At the end of its next turn, it repeats the save. Failure: **Unconscious** for the duration (see the condition).

Step 4 – Waking:

The spell ends on a target that takes damage, or when a creature within 5 ft uses its action to shake it.

Example: Maëlle (Bard, DC 13) casts Sleep on two goblins. The first (Wisdom 8) fails: Incapacitated. At the end of its turn, it repeats the save and fails: Unconscious. The second succeeds on its first save: no effect.

⚠ Common questions:

How many saves?

Two: one on casting, one at the end of the target's next turn.

Does damage wake the target?

Yes: the spell ends on a target that takes damage.

How do I wake an ally?

A creature within 5 ft uses its action to shake it.

What about undead?

Creatures immune to Exhaustion automatically succeed.

Can they sleep forever?

No: concentration lasts 1 minute at most.

Does it hit every creature?

Only those you choose in the Sphere.

Must I see the target?

You need a point within range, not necessarily the target. Table rule

What does Incapacitated do?

The creature can't take actions or Reactions (see the condition).

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

Elves

The text says creatures that don't sleep, "such as elves", automatically succeed. **Option**: follow the text; or let the DM decide by the species at the table.

Who chooses targets?

The caster chooses among the creatures in the Sphere. **Option**: allies excluded; or all creatures in the Sphere.

Attacking a sleeper

An Unconscious creature grants Advantage on attacks against it, and hits within 5 ft are Critical Hits. But damage wakes it: **option**: one hit kills or wakes.

Waking by action

Option: the wake-up action succeeds automatically; or requires a check.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Ending the spell

The caster can voluntarily end a spell that isn't instantaneous.

Concentration: range and sight

To keep concentrating, you don't need to stay in range or keep the spell in sight, unless the spell or another feature says so.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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